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M. B. A. Examination, April-May, 2015

(New Scheme)

(Management Branch)

EMERGING ISSUES in HR MANAGEMENT

Time Allowed : Three hours

Maximum Marks : 80

Minimum Pass Marks : 32

Note : *The question paper comprises of three sections (a), (b) and (c). All questions are compulsory and internal choice is given in each section.*

Section-'A'

1. Identify the changing trends in HRM environment with special reference to India. 11

Or

How is performance of an expatriate appraised? How does it differ from appraising that of a home employee? Also delineate the perspective of international HRM. 11

2. Define virtual organization. What are the various types of virtual organizations? Distinguish virtual organizations from traditional/face to face organizations. 11

Or

What is HR Audit? Explain the scope and benefits of HR Audit. 11

3. What do you understand by Human Resource Account? Explain the need and objective of HR Accounting alongwith its limitations. 11

Or

Explain the various methods of valuation of Human Resource? 11

4. What do you understand by Human Resource Information System? Explain its needs and advantages. 11

Or

How will you design an Human Resource Information System in an Industrial Organization? 11

5. What do you understand by competency mapping? Explain its importance alongwith the factors which should not be overlooked while doing competency mapping. 11

Or

What is meant by Flexiwork? Explain its benefits in context to an organization related to Marketing/Production/Distribution. 11

Section-'B'

6. Write short notes on : (any two) 10

(i) Controlling cost of Human Resource

(ii) Importance of Induction Programme

(iii) Limitation of HRIS

(iv) Process of HR Audit in brief

(v) Six sigma

Section-'C'

Case Study

7. Read the following case carefully and answer the questions given at the end : 15

Microelectronics, a California-based electronics defence contractor, has enjoyed a smooth growth curve over the past five years, primarily because of favourable defence funding during the Reagan administration's build-up of U. S. military defences. Microelectronics has had numerous contracts to design and develope guidance and radar systems for military weaponry.

Although the favourable funding cycle has enabled Microelectronics to grow at a steady rate, the company is finding it increasingly difficult to keep its really good engineers. Based on extensive turnover analyses conducted by Ned Jackson, the human resource planning manager, Microelectronics' problem seems to be its inability to keep engineers beyond the 'critical' five year point. Apparently, the probability of turnover drops dramatically after five years of service.

Ned's conclusion is that Microelectronics has been essentially serving as an industry college. Their staffing strategy has always been to hire the best and brightest engineers from the best engineering schools in the United States.

Ned believes that these engineers often get lost in the shuffle at the time they join the firm. Form example, most (if not all) of the new hires must work on non-classified projects until cleared by security to join a designated major project Security clearance usually takes anywhere from six to ten months. In the meantime the major project has started, and these young engineers frequently miss out on its design phase, considered the most creative and challenging segment of the program.

Because of the nature of project work, new engineers often have difficulty learning the organizational culture - such as who to ask when you have a problem, what the general do's and don'ts are, and why the organization does things in a certain way. After heading a task force of human resource professionals within Microelectronics, Ned has been designated to present to top management a proposal designed to reduce turnover among young engineering recruits. The essence of his plan is to create a mentor program, except that in this plan the mentors will not be the seasoned gray beards of Microelectronics, but rather those engineers in the critical three-to-five year service window, the period of highest turnover. These engineers will be paired with new engineering recruits before the recruits actually report to Micro-electronics for work.

According to the task force, the programme is two-fold : it benefits the newcomer by easing the transition into the company, and it helps the three-to-five-year service engineers by enabling them to serve an important role for the company.

By performing the mentor role, these engineers will become more committed and hence less likely to leave. As Ned prepared his fifteen-minute presentation for top management, he wondered if he had adequately anticipated the possible objections to the program in order to make an intelligent defence of it. Only time would tell.

Case Questions :

(a) Based on the programme as described, who are the primary beneficiaries? If you were to study this turnover problem, how could you conduct a needs analysis?

(b) How would you evaluate the effectiveness of the proposed program assuming it was implemented?

(c) Is turnover necessarily bad for Microelectronics? How could they decide if their turnover is too high?

(d) Suppose that the President of Microelectronics responds to the proposal by asking how the first-line supervisors are involved in the program? In other words, the President fears that the mentors will only

serve as crutches for first-line supervisors who are not doing their jobs in the first place. As Ned Jackson, how would you respond? Are there other negative aspects of Ned's programme? Explain.